



Choosing the Right Remodeling Contractor

A concise guide to licensing, scope clarity, communication and fair comparison.

HOMEOWNER RESOURCE

Use this resource to organize decisions and prepare for productive conversations with your contractor, designer and local building department.

Compare More Than Price

A lower number may represent less scope, smaller allowances, missing permits or different assumptions. Compare written inclusions, exclusions, product standards, supervision and closeout—not only the total.

Verify the Basics

- Business name matches proposals and contracts
- License is active and appropriate for the work
- Insurance documentation is current
- References relate to similar scope
- The contractor explains permits and inspections clearly

Look for Process Clarity

- Defined communication schedule
- Written selection deadlines
- Documented change-order procedure
- Realistic start and completion expectations
- Clear payment milestones tied to progress

Warning Signs

- Pressure to sign immediately
- Large unexplained upfront payment
- Unwillingness to provide written scope
- Requests to avoid permits without a clear legal basis
- Vague answers about supervision or insurance

Project Notes

Educational resource only. Costs, schedules, permit requirements and construction methods vary by property, scope and jurisdiction. Confirm project-specific requirements with qualified professionals and the applicable authority.